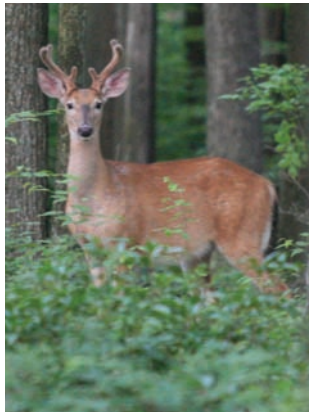


Appendix H: Case Studies and Best Practices



Below are a collection of outdoor recreation-based programs and projects that were referenced during the 2009-2013 planning process as case studies or best practices. Throughout the life of the plan, additional stories will be collected and shared on www.paoutdoorrecplan.com to highlight successful implementation of the plan's recommendations and action steps.

To learn more about a program or project, just click on its title below.

- [Fayette County Walks for Health and History](#)
- [PA Wilds Conservation Landscape Model](#)
- [“Trail Towns” Rebounding](#)
- [Taking Trails Seriously in Chester County: *Trail & Path Planning: A Guide for Municipalities*](#)
- [A Passport for Fun in the Outdoors/ Steps to a Healthier Luzerne](#)
- [Pymatuning State Park Stimulates Local Tourism Through Eagle Watch](#)
- [An Outdoor Classroom – A Rural School and Nature Next Door](#)
- [A Trail to Every Classroom](#)
- [Pedal-Paddle-Peduto Hike and Learn Series](#)
- [DCNR Adventure Camp – Engaging Urban Youth](#)
- [Corrections Provides Connections](#)
- [The Pennsylvania Conservation Corps – Helping Youth Help Outdoor Recreation](#)
- [Discovering the Susquehanna: Interpretive Master Plan Reveals Heritage & Tourism Potential](#)
- [Delaware and Lehigh National Heritage Corridor – *Where America was Built* Trail Tenders Program](#)
- [Buy Fresh, Bike Local](#)
- [Trailhead Does Double Duty](#)
- [Bluebird Cam](#)
- [Sowing Seeds Charity Bike Ride](#)
- [Carlisle Area Health & Wellness Foundation](#)

Fayette County Walks for Health and History

(Supports Recommendation 1.2)



In 2007, Steps to a HealthierPA Fayette County and the Fayette County Healthy Lifestyles Task Force began a Wednesday evening walking series to improve residents' health and their appreciation of the county's historical, cultural and natural features. With leaders offering encouragement and interpretation, participants walked at 16 different Fayette County sites during the program's first summer. In 2008, the program expanded to 32 walks and attracted 1,500 participants.

The outings attracted walkers aged 2 to 87; from 31 zip codes across southwestern Pennsylvania. Although the primary goal was to promote exercise as a way to prevent and manage obesity, diabetes and cardiovascular disease, comments from participants and sponsors point to additional benefits. Walkers enjoyed the opportunity for family bonding through structured outings and local businesses reported increased sales. On one Wednesday evening, at least 15 walkers visited a restaurant near the end of the route. For more information, go to www.stepstohealthierfayettecounty.org.

Pennsylvania Wilds Conservation Landscape Model

(Supports Recommendation 1.2)



Imagine two million acres of pristine forest, all available to the public and laced by hundreds of miles of hiking and biking trails, 16,000 miles of streams for fishing and paddling amid mountain scenery, and accented by history-rich small towns. Add to that the Northeast's largest herd of wild elk, and you could be in only one place—the Pennsylvania Wilds, a 12-county region of northcentral and northwestern Pennsylvania that many consider the most densely-packed landscape of outdoor recreation potential in the eastern United States. Beginning in 2002, the Commonwealth advanced a strategy across the region aimed at boosting tourism and related businesses that depend on visitors' and residents enjoyment of quality outdoor experience.

The strategic intent of the Pennsylvania Wilds initiative is to simultaneously conserve the region's natural assets and revitalize communities by helping local business realize value from a relatively pristine natural landscape. To date, DCNR has invested \$128 million at state park and state forest facilities in the region, and \$14 million in community recreation sites through its Community Conservation and Partnership program. Community facilities complement surrounding state recreational lands and are considered vital to attracting future private investment. And as DCNR has improved and expanded recreational facilities, the state's Tourism Office has invested \$5 million to attract new visitors.

Already, these investments are paying off for the Pennsylvania Wilds. New businesses have sprung up and others have expanded operations. The region experienced an increase in leisure visitors from 3.5 million to 4.1 million from 2004-07 and the revenue per available room growth in the Pa Wilds was 13 percent from 2007-2008, strongest of all the state's tourism regions. For more information, visit: www.pawildsresources.org or www.PAWilds.com.

"Trail Towns" Rebounding *(Supports Recommendation 1.5)*



The Great Allegheny Passage (GAP) is a 150-mile trail that leads cyclists and hikers through stunning mountain scenery and along whitewater rivers across Somerset, Fayette, Westmoreland and Allegheny counties. When the last gaps near McKeesport are completed, the Passage will connect Pittsburgh with Cumberland, MD, and to Washington, DC via the C&O Canal Towpath. Even now, the combined trails—318 miles in length—represent the longest multiple use trail in

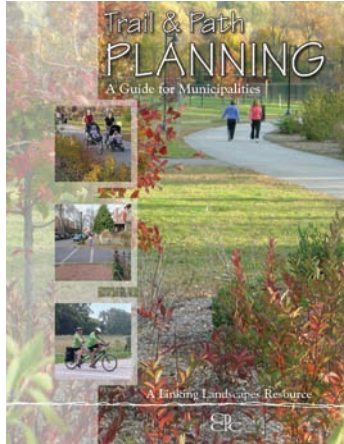
the nation and the GAP has become one of Pennsylvania's premier outdoor destinations. In 2008, GAP attracted more than 750,000 users, generated \$12 million in spending and boosted business along its route by 18 percent. New businesses serving trail users are springing up in these "Trail Towns" from the Maryland border to the Pittsburgh suburbs. GAP's reinvigorating impact is especially important in small towns like West Newton and Connellsville that have struggled with economic stagnation since mines and mills closed decades ago. For example, The River's Edge Café and B&B, on the banks of the Youghiogheny River in the welcoming mountain town of Confluence, is a favorite of GAP cyclists. For more information the 2008 Trail Town Economic Impact Study and other on trail town opportunities visit www.trailtowns.org.

Reference: 2008 Trail Town Economic Impact Study (Phase II: Trail User Survey), Progress Fund and Laurel Highlands Visitor Bureau, 2009 (<http://www.trailtowns.org/>).

Taking Trails Seriously in Chester County:

Trail & Path Planning: A Guide for Municipalities

(Supports Recommendation 1.6)



The Pennsylvania Outdoor Recreation Plan encourages local land use policy that promotes more walkable communities and provides safe connections to outdoor recreation amenities. Chester County Planning Commission developed this excellent guidebook to assist municipalities that wish to address trails and paths in their comprehensive plan, official map, zoning ordinance and subdivision and land development ordinances. As noted in the guidebook many Chester County municipalities never had to address the need for trails in their community, but that situation is rapidly changing. In some rural municipalities, with wooded areas or abandoned rail corridors, trails are now being considered as a way to attract trail users to older village centers that are in need of revitalization. In more developed areas that have experienced growth, municipal officials find themselves trying to meet the growing recreation needs of their constituents in an environment where there is less open land available for new parks. In many of these communities, the solution to this dilemma is to establish public trails.

Using this guidebook, municipal officials can elevate trails to their deserved importance among other public infrastructure and approach trail development with the same seriousness as a highway project. This guidebook can also be used by individuals who wish to learn more about how public trails and paths are planned and constructed by local governments. To access this publication, go to www.chesco.org/planning (hit open space planning tab).

A Passport for Fun in the Outdoors/ Steps to a Healthier Luzerne

(Supports Recommendation 2.2)

The Luzerne County Passport is a free guide encouraging people of all ages and abilities to get outdoors and get active. A collection of passport stops highlight close-to-home state and county parks, trails and free events throughout the summer – all within a 10-60-minute drive from anywhere in the county. Users visit as many featured stops as they wish, and log answers to scavenger hunt questions on a website. Prizes are awarded, and chances to win increase as more stops are visited.



The Passport program's three cooperating organizations—the Wyoming Valley Wellness Trails Partnership, the Greater Hazleton Rails to Trails, and Steps to a Healthier Luzerne County offer fun and free prizes to participants but their intent is to introduce area residents to the joys and benefits of outdoor activity, and to help them reconnect with nearby nature in the process.

According to the PA Department of Health, more than 25% of Luzerne County residents report no regular participation in physical activity, and more than 63% of adults are overweight. Overweight trends in children are on the rise, and one local school district reports that 46% of its 5th-grade students had Body Mass Indexes above the 85th percentile, an indicator for obesity in children. Increased physical activity is recommended to help manage weight; is known to improve overall physical and mental health; helps combat heart disease, diabetes, and certain types of cancer; and helps seniors remain independent longer.

The Luzerne County Keystone Active Zone (KAZ) Passport program helps to turn some of that “screen time” into “green time” for the whole family. KAZ gives kids opportunities to discover and connect with their natural world, activities that will help them learn to value, preserve, and protect the environment. Companies can also use the passport program in their workplace wellness efforts.

In addition to the promise of free fun and great prizes, there are lots of reasons to get out and get moving with the KAZ Passport program. The program’s three coordinating organizations—the Wyoming Valley Wellness Trails Partnership, the Greater Hazleton Rails to Trails, and Steps To A Healthier PA Luzerne County—want everyone, young and old, to get moving and active for their health, now and in the future.

To learn more, visit: http://www.stepstohealthierluzernecounty.org/lc_trail.php

Pymatuning State Park Stimulates Local Tourism Through Eagle Watch *(Supports Recommendation 2.2)*

Environmental interpretation specialists at Pymatuning State Park in Crawford County offer an Eagle Eco-Tour on weekends during late winter. Participants visit various sites in and near the park where they can watch bald eagles from a distance without disturbing the birds’ hunting and nesting behavior. Interpretive staff explain the bald eagle’s impressive recovery in the state, and help participants learn to identify waterfowl and other wildlife. As part of the tour, groups also visit local restaurants, a wildlife rehabilitation facility, and a local winery. The Eagle Eco-Tours stimulate local business at a time of year when visitor traffic is normally low, and help expand public awareness of northwestern Pennsylvania’s unique wetland wildlife community.



“Eagle-viewing goes well with our philosophy—relax and enjoy the eagles and a sample of our wine,” said Gary Shilling, co-owner of Wilhelm Winery, a stop on the Eco-Tour. “All this kind of fits together—the bike trails, the lake, and now the eagles. We try to be a good hometown host for all of it.” For more information about Pymatuning State Park, visit: <http://www.dcnr.state.pa.us/stateParks/parks/pymatuning.aspx>

An Outdoor Classroom – A Rural School and Nature Next Door *(Supports Recommendation 2.3)*

For modern schools, getting kids out of the classroom for real, dirt-on-the-sneakers, nature-based educational experiences can be a challenge. Even in districts with funding and support from school administrators, teachers and parents; the logistics can be overwhelming. But nature is everywhere, and innovative educators can find ways to link lessons to the natural world under kids' noses – and on a shoe-string budget.



Take-Lack Tuscarora Elementary School, a small, rural K-5th in the Juniata County School District, where schoolyard nature yields dividends in educational programming for students.

For the last three years, Scott Sanderson's third grade class has participated in the Backyard bird-watching program. They keep a list of bird species spotted from the classroom windows. In addition, the school's front yard was converted into a flower and vegetable garden. Beginning with a butterfly garden to draw monarchs close to the fifth grade classroom window, the project expanded to include gourds, tomatoes, summer squash, watermelon, brussel sprouts, cabbage, and, to cut costs; sunflower seeds for the kids to shell for winter bird feeding.

With help from teachers, school staff, and some parents, kids helped grow, weed, and harvest the veggies. The educational rewards of the school garden were numerous and in many cases, edible. The school kitchen staff helped kids make salsa to sell as a fundraiser and provided fresh veggie trays at the fall open house. "The chapter on plant reproduction got a lot more interesting to kids with the garden as their "lab" and a last period watermelon party as the reward for good science," fifth-grade teacher Hunter Hart laughs.

A Trail to Every Classroom *(Supports Recommendation 2.3)*



A Trail to Every Classroom (TTEC) is a three-season, multi-disciplinary professional development series aimed at providing teachers with the inspiration, knowledge and skills they need to transform classroom teaching into effective and exciting place-based education.

Teachers who participate in TTEC develop their own curriculum to improve student literacy skills and foster understanding of and appreciation for the public lands and resources connected by the Appalachian Trail. At

the heart of TTEC is the belief that students immersed in the interdisciplinary study of their own “place” are more eager to get involved in caring for their communities and public lands.

With Pennsylvania’s 232 Appalachian Trail miles passing close to many communities, including Harrisburg, the state capital, the Trail to Every Classroom Program presents a great opportunity for educators in southcentral and eastern regions of the state. Currently, the Commonwealth is an active TTEC partner, providing funding and staff, and offering continued support for Pennsylvania teachers following their participation. More information can be found at and/or www.nps.gov/appa and/or www.appalachiantrail.org

Pedal-Paddle-Peduto Hike and Learn Series ***(Supports Recommendation 2.4)***

What happens when you mix outdoor activities with public policy discussions, while enjoying Pittsburgh’s natural beauty and amenities? You get Pedal, Paddle, Peduto. This summer, Venture Outdoors and City Councilman William Peduto joined forces to create a unique opportunity for people to learn about civic design, architecture and the environment while hiking, biking or kayaking through Pittsburgh’s striking urban landscape.



Each outing featured expert speaker/guides on topics like riverfront development and design, parks, trails and urban planning. On one outing, three city experts were joined by 30 curious city residents, sparking a bike-propelled discussion covering the architecture of history and progress, the unique art of stone, glass and steel, and the blossoming potential of urban waterfronts. As a result, participants gained new perspectives on the city each calls home.

Such multifaceted programs are the hallmark of Venture Outdoors, a nonprofit organization whose beginner-friendly outdoor recreation offerings blend physical activity with environmental education and civic engagement in a supportive atmosphere. Each year Venture Outdoors introduces over 30,000 participants from western Pennsylvania and beyond to healthy, active lifestyles amid the region’s outdoors. For more information visit: www.ventureoutdoors.org.

DCNR Adventure Camp – Engaging Urban Youth

(Supports Recommendation 2.4)



To excite urban youth about outdoor recreation, DCNR's Bureau of State Parks, in partnership with city park and recreation departments and youth organizations, initiated a new Adventure Camp program. The partners held eight camps in 2009, one each in Erie, Pittsburgh, Williamsport, York, Harrisburg, Scranton, Philadelphia and the Lehigh Valley.

The weeklong day camps introduced urban youngsters (ages 13-15) to outdoor recreation opportunities more commonly associated

with Pennsylvania's state parks and forests, and showed how those same skills can be practiced back home in their neighborhoods. Partners will evaluate the camps' success in cultivating new outdoor recreationists and work to connect participants with more opportunities near their homes. For more information about Adventure Camp contact the Bureau of State Parks Outdoor Programming Services Division at 717-783-4356.



Corrections Provides Connections

(Supports Recommendation 3.1)



When Montgomery County Department of Parks and Heritage and other partners began piecing together a Rails to Trails project on the old Reading Railroad (Perkiomen Trail), the Department of Corrections-Graterford Prison became an important partner in making the project work. Trail routing narrowed down to two options. One route could utilize existing railroad infrastructure that cut across a corner of Graterford's land. The other required right-of-way negotiations with many different adjoining landowners. "It really was a no-

brainer connection once you looked at it," said George Hiltner, facility manager at Graterford.

An old railroad spur, including a 400' long bridge, historically used to supply the prison provided a key linkage. The bridge, along with a ½-mile section adjacent to Perkiomen Creek allowed the trail to cross the creek, and continue north into the county's Central Perkiomen Valley Park.

The link was crucial in completing the now 20-mile Perkiomen Trail from Oaks to Green Lane, enjoyed by 200,000 walkers, runners, cyclists and equestrians each year. It also illustrates the potential for partnerships that emerge when state and local government agencies share a commitment to making the most of available opportunities for outdoor recreation.

The Pennsylvania Conservation Corps – Helping Youth Help Outdoor Recreation ***(Supports Recommendation 3.2)***

The Weiser State Forest District straddles the ridges and valleys east of the Susquehanna River in Dauphin and Schuylkill counties. Since 2007, the Weiser Forest District has sponsored a highly successful Pennsylvania Conservation Corps (PCC) Program with a goal to develop life and trade skills, self confidence and work ethic in young adults through hands-on projects that develop and restore natural and recreational resources. Educational opportunities are also available for PCC crewmembers.

The Weiser crew is headquartered at Bear Gap Fire Control Station, and has concentrated its efforts at the newly acquired Roaring Creek Tract. Work projects include: Improvement of hiking trails, installation of trail markers, construction of boat mooring docks, and improvements to Bear Gap and Locust Valley Fire Control Stations. Across the Commonwealth, the PCC helps maintain and improve the outdoor recreation resources of the state forests, while providing life-long skills for young adults.



Discovering the Susquehanna: Interpretive Master Plan Reveals Heritage & Tourism Potential

(Supports Recommendation 3.6)



The 500-mile Susquehanna Greenway links 22 Pennsylvania counties and a multitude of recreational, historic, environmental, and cultural assets along the Susquehanna River's West Branch, North Branch and Main Stem. In many ways the Greenway probes the very heart of Pennsylvania. To heighten the public's awareness of these river corridor-based assets and to accent their common relationship to the entire Susquehanna watershed, the Susquehanna Greenway Partnership developed an Interpretive

Master Plan for the Susquehanna River Water Trail and Susquehanna Greenway.

The plan recommends developing interpretive media (signs, online tour guides, brochures, podcasts, etc.) that link resources and attractions under the Susquehanna Greenway brand. The Partnership hopes these educational resources will help visitors and residents discover, explore and understand the river corridor and to remember 'Susquehanna Greenway,' as a destination.

For more information on the Interpretive Master Plan go to: <http://www.susquehannagreenway.org/greenway/cwp/view.asp?a=3&Q=450775&greenwayNav=|7899|>

Delaware and Lehigh National Heritage Corridor – Where America was Built Trail Tenders Program

(Supports Recommendation 3.6)

Volunteers Link America's Past and Present

The Delaware & Lehigh National Heritage Corridor includes hundreds of natural and historic site. The D&L Trail provides access to these sites to walkers, bikers, cross-country skiers and equestrian riders. Maintenance of the trails is assumed by the D&L Trail Tenders, an association of volunteer groups who work from White Haven to Easton.



Trail Tenders provide litter cleanups; repair drainage problems; patch trails; clean and replace signs; control invasive plants; plant native species; and undertake trail enhancement projects. Their work helps enable the public to visit historic canals, railroads and scenic natural areas. Without Trail Tenders, the Corridor's heritage would be far less visible.

Trail Tenders Organize Regionally

Trail Tenders are organized into four regional chapters: Carbon County/Lehigh Gorge, Northern Lehigh, Lehigh Valley, and Easton, which is responsible for the city's eight-mile Hugh Moore Park. Each chapter undertakes projects in its own geographic area and conducts regular planning meetings and outreach activities. Trail Tenders come from many walks of life but they all have a common goal: preserve the D&L Trail and the history and natural beauty alongside it.

Trail Tenders Have Many Accomplishments

Trail Tenders have a keen interest in the history of the Delaware and Lehigh national Heritage Corridor. Every year, volunteers clean and stabilize 170-year-old locks on the Upper Grand section of the Lehigh Canal. They have unearthed and cleaned out a 19th century railroad turntable in Lehigh Gorge State Park. In Bethlehem, Tenders are clearing a large area around Lock 43 in hope of create a site for canal interpretation. They have also reclaimed 1.5 acres of land along the Lehigh River and turned it into the Sane Island native Plant Preserve.

Since the program's inception, more that 5,000 volunteer Trail Tenders have accumulated 30,000 hours maintaining and enhancing historic route of trade and commerce.

Become a Trail Tender! Get involved in the preservation of history and natural resources n the Delaware and Lehigh National Heritage Corridor. Call our office or check our website for opportunities and events in your area.

For more information visit:
www.delawareandlehigh.org

Buy Fresh, Bike Local *(Supports Recommendation 4.5)*

The agricultural landscapes of southcentral and southeastern Pennsylvania are as scenic as they are productive, and in the fall of 2008 the Buy Fresh Buy Local campaign partnered with area bike clubs, non-profit organizations, farmers and businesses to heighten awareness of both those attributes. The partners sponsored "buy fresh bike local" bike tours, to demonstrate the proximity of local produce to population centers and the ease of buying high quality food grown within peddling distance of home. The southcentral tour stopped at nine farms on its 27-mile route through Cumberland County. Both the southcentral and southeastern Pennsylvania Buy Fresh Buy Local campaigns plan more bike rides during the 2009 growing season and beyond. For more information, visit: www.msacd.cas.psu.edu.



Trailhead Does Double Duty

(Supports Recommendation 4.5)



The rest stop along state road 322 at the top of Seven Mountains in Centre County combines road improvements and recreational opportunities in a model that could be replicated widely across the state. At the peak of the mountain on this heavily used truck route, there is a need for a truck pull-off to either check brakes, engines, loads, and alertness levels before either a twelve mile descent or grueling climb. Safety dictated that Penn DOT provide a place for truckers to get their rigs off the highway for a

breathing spell. Biology dictated that a rest area be provided. And creative planning helped develop a connector trail from the rest area to the nearby Mid-state trail, featuring a popular vista of the Big Valley.

Designing the rest area to also function as a trail head for a popular long distance hiking trail serves both motorists and recreationalists well. The rest area allows day hikers to access a popular portion of the mid-state trail as a short, day loop event. It also encourages truckers and other motorists to get out and stretch their legs for a short fifteen minute walk to the vista. Not a bad way to get the blood flowing, calm the nerves, and get ready for the other side of the mountain.

Bluebird Cam

(Supports Recommendation 4.8)

In spring 2009, the Pennsylvania Game Commission set up a small camera that transmits video and audio of a bluebird nest to the Web for public viewing. Staff set up the camera at a nest box 300 feet from PGC headquarters in Harrisburg, ran cable underground into the building and connected it to a TV monitor in the lobby. The monitor shows live video and audio of what's going on in the nest box.

On April 10, 2009 eastern bluebirds, black-capped chickadees and English sparrows began inspecting the box. The inspections by various species went on until April 16, when the bluebirds established residence and continued nest building until May 1. The first pale blue egg appeared on May 5, and the last of four on May 9.



From May 10 through 21, the female bluebird incubated her clutch. The first three eggs hatched during the early hours of May 22. The fourth hatched over the Memorial Day weekend. Delighted visitors watched the female feed the hatchlings across the days that followed. Look for the Bluebird Live-Feed link on the PGC webpage at <http://www.pgc.state.pa.us/pgc/cwp/view.asp?a=521&q=176641>.

Sowing Seeds Charity Bike Ride

(Supports Recommendation 4.9)



The Lehigh Valley has experienced rapid growth in recent years, annually losing nearly four square miles of agricultural land to sprawl and development. To slow farmland loss, support new farm enterprises, and provide a dependable source of locally grown food, Lehigh County started an agricultural incubator project in 2009 called “the Seed Farm.” To raise money for the project, supporters sponsor 5-mile, 20-mile and 40-mile bike rides through Lehigh Valley’s farming country, called “Sowing Seeds.” The rides raise

awareness of local land-use issues while offering outdoor recreation to participants. For more information on Sowing Seeds visit: www.lehighconservation.org.

Carlisle Area Health & Wellness Foundation

(Supports Recommendations 1.1, 1.4, 1.6 and Funding Recommendations 3 and 5)

In September 2004 the Carlisle Area Health & Wellness Foundation (CAHWF) convened a Prevention and Education Task Force to study opportunities for supporting health strategies. Task Force members realized early on there was a consistent theme when examining the nation’s top chronic diseases. Unlike many acute illnesses, chronic conditions are generally not caused by infection agents or public sanitation problems, as was the case 100 years ago. Instead, chronic disease largely results from behavior



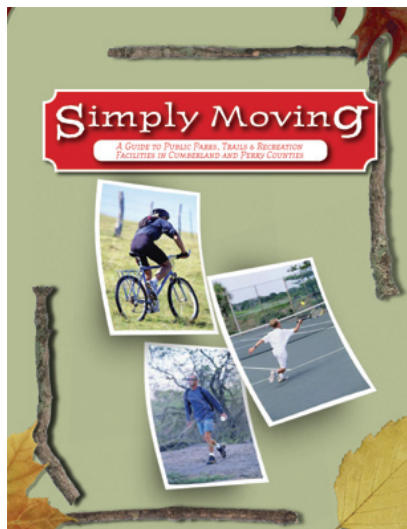
The three most important behavioral factors contributing to preventable chronic disease are cigarette smoking (use of tobacco products), poor diet and lack of regular exercise. To reduce chronic disease in the Cumberland Valley region, the Foundation began small steps to address these behavioral factors.

In October 2007, the Foundation, along with the Cumberland County Planning Commission hosted the *Healthy Community Design – More than a Walk in the Park* training event. The event featured national walking expert Mark Fenton, who is driven by a passion for finding ways to create more livable, walk/bike-able, activity-friendly communities. The 2007 event marked the second time Fenton spoke in Carlisle and his agenda went beyond a general overview of the issues. All area residents and officials with a willingness and/or ability to work together to make the local environment more walker/pedestrian-friendly were invited.

Fenton generated recommendations for a safer, more walkable community based on his observations and feedback from participants, summarized as “Ten Elements for an Active Carlisle Region.” The ten elements varied from “Reduce truck traffic downtown” to “Launch a *Safe Routes to School* program.”

Many initiatives arose from this Task force and the Fenton consultation. Below are those designed to encourage physical activity:

CRANA (Carlisle Regional Advocates for Nutrition and Activity): In 2005, CAHWF established a regional collaboration to champion and monitor local nutrition and activity strategies. CRANA is a task force with broad representation from youth/school, community and the workplace.



Simply Moving: A Guide to Public Parks, Trails & Recreation Facilities in Cumberland and Perry Counties: CAHWF partnered with the Cumberland County Planning Commission to publish a guide to outdoor recreation in Cumberland and Perry Counties. The guide promotes use of close-to-home parks and trails as great places for physical activity. Aimed primarily at encouraging walking, the guide also provides information about parks, trails and other public recreation facilities, as well as amenities available at each site.

Simply Moving Walking Initiative: CAHWF and the Carlisle Parks & Recreation Department offer a free 8-week walking program to introduce the community to walkable locations featured in the *Simply Moving* walking guide.

Safe Routes to School Assessment and Strategy Initiative: CAHWF provided funding for a community partnership focused on resurrecting the daily routine of walking or biking to school. Initial assessments were followed by additional funding to implement the project in three pilot schools. One school has already instituted its first “Walking School Bus” with great results. Another introduced a “Drop and Walk” project to promote walking safety in the school neighborhood.

Comprehensive Traffic Study of Downtown Carlisle: CAHWF contributed a small amount of money to a study of traffic patterns in the Borough of Carlisle. That study led, in 2009, to a \$2.8 million Pennsylvania Community Transportation Initiative grant to the borough from PennDot to fund a road diet project.

The Carlisle community is being challenged to create an environment that encourages physical activity and sensibly cuts down on automotive and truck traffic. The initiative is supported by Dickinson College, Carlisle Borough, Cumberland County, CAHWF, the Downtown Carlisle Association and the LeTort Regional Authority.

To learn more about CAHWF and its efforts, go to www.cahwf.org.